CELEBRATING THE LIFE

# matilde

**Matilde Alivillar Olague**

**Sunday, July 5, 2026**
**Mary Immaculate Catholic Church**
**5 p.m.**

**2800 Valwood Pkwy**
**Farmers Branch, Texas**

CELEBRATING THE LIFE

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**A Legacy of Purpose**
Matilde, known affectionately as "Tillie," was more than a resident of Puerto Palomas; she was its heartbeat. Born the eldest of 13 children to Luis and Elodia Olague, she was raised with a deep sense of responsibility and industry. A graduate of the Radford School for Girls and Palmore Business College, she moved with grace between languages and cultures, building a life defined by entrepreneurial grit and radical kindness.

**The Entrepreneurial Spirit**
In 1943, Matilde married Arnulfo Alvillar, and together they built an empire of service. From grocery stores and pharmacies to a beauty salon and a liquor distributorship, Matilde was a visionary. She even designed modern Mexican dresses for export and shared her voice as a columnist for two New Mexico newspapers. She proved to her family that a woman's creativity and business acumen could reshape a community.

**A Heart for the People**
For her grandchildren, Matilde's greatest lesson was her compassion. When she saw the indigent elderly struggling, she found them housing and turned their crafts into a source of income. When she saw children without seats in local schools, she didn't wait for the government—she opened her own classrooms, hired teachers, and ensured every student had a hot breakfast. She taught us that leadership isn't about a title; it's about filling the gaps where others see only obstacles.

**The Matriarch's Grace**
Matilde was a woman of "Border Ballyhoo" and high-level politics, yet she always remained the elegant soul who valued family above all. She leaves behind a massive, living legacy: 16 grandchildren, 20 great-grandchildren, and two great-great-grandchildren. Though she joins her husband Arnulfo and son José Francisco in rest, her spirit of "enlightened community" remains our guiding light.

**Matilde Olague Armendariz Alivillar**
July 5, 1923 — December 27, 2021